

Letter

Election-Denying Republican Candidates Underperformed in the 2022 Midterms

JANET MALZAHN *Stanford University, United States*ANDREW B. HALL *Stanford University, United States*

Causal (yellow)

RD (green)

Data (blue)

Findings (pink)

Bckgd (purple)

We combine newly collected election data with records of public denials of the results of the 2020 election to estimate the degree to which election-denying Republican candidates over- or underperformed other Republicans in 2022 in statewide and federal elections. We find that the average vote share of election-denying Republicans in statewide races was approximately 3.2 percentage points lower than their co-partisans after accounting for state-level partisanship. However, we find no such underperformance on aggregate for U.S. House elections, perhaps due to the more-partisan nature of many House districts. Together, the results suggest that the types of candidates in American elections who take more-extreme positions tend to underperform, but that these performance gaps are relatively small in the present, polarized political environment.

INTRODUCTION

In 2022, denying the 2020 election's outcome became an explicit campaign strategy for many Republican candidates. In the end, a number of high-profile candidates who denied the 2020 election lost their races in 2022, leading some to argue that the American electorate had rejected this movement. National Public Radio (NPR), to choose one of many examples, ran a headline declaring "Midterm results show voters reject election denialism."¹ Others disagree. For example, pointing to many election-denying candidates who won their races, a 538 article wrote that "election denial is alive and well."² What can data tell us about the extent to which voters did or did not reject these candidates in 2022?

To provide hard data on this important question, we gather new 2022 primary and general election data on key statewide and federal offices—U.S. Senate, U.S. House, governor, secretary of state, and attorney general—and combine them with systematic data on which candidates explicitly denied the 2020 election

outcome publicly. Using several statistical approaches to account for partisan differences across states and offices, we estimate that election-denying candidates for statewide offices underperformed their fellow Republicans who did not deny the 2020 election by roughly 3.2 percentage points, on average. While this difference is small by some standards, it constitutes a large enough vote-share swing to have changed important, close elections in recent cycles.³ For example, in 2022, there were 20 statewide races in our data in which the winning candidate received less than 53% of the two-party vote—with these races clustered in the most-contested battleground states including Arizona, Georgia, Pennsylvania, and Wisconsin. As such, the estimated underperformance seems relevant for the debate over the electability of Republican candidates in the 2024 primary cycle.

Our study adds to two very recent studies of the 2022 election cycle. Jacobson (2023) analyzes the midterm congressional elections as a whole, and uses one of the measures of election denialism we also use in regressions that suggest a modest or null underperformance to election-denying candidates.⁴ Bartels and Carnes (2023) studied the U.S. House and found that, among incumbents, election-denying candidates received higher average vote shares, using a measure of election denying based on votes in Congress. We expand on these studies in three key ways. First, because measuring

Janet Malzahn , Ph.D. Student, Stanford Graduate School of Business, Stanford University, United States, jmalzahn@stanford.edu

Corresponding author: Andrew B. Hall , Davies Family Professor of Political Economy, Graduate School of Business, Stanford University, United States; Senior Fellow, Hoover Institution, United States, andrewbhall@stanford.edu

Received: May 02, 2023; revised: November 16, 2023; accepted: July 24, 2024. First published online: October 28, 2024.

¹ <https://www.npr.org/2022/11/23/1138875937/midterm-results-show-voters-reject-election-denialism>.

² <https://fivethirtyeight.com/features/election-denialism-lives-on-even-as-candidates-who-support-it-concede/>.

³ The underperformance that we estimate is also roughly similar in magnitude to survey-based estimates provided in Graham and Svobik (2020), which argues that relatively few Americans will trade off ideological or partisan considerations to support the democratic process itself.

⁴ Jacobson (2023) does discuss the presence of a underperformance in statewide races, but does not report formal results for these.

election-denying candidates is a subjective exercise, we make sure that results are not driven by a particular data source by incorporating four different measures of election denialism that apply to both incumbents and non-incumbents. Second, we analyze all relevant statewide and federal offices, including both incumbents and non-incumbents.⁵ Third, we develop analyses that are explicitly focused on estimating the gap in performance between election-denying and non-denying candidates, holding electoral factors fixed, without including any potentially mediating variables like campaign finance measures that may be posttreatment and could bias estimates.⁶ To do so, we employ state fixed effects so that we can compare the gap in performance for election-denying and non-denying candidates who ran on the same ballot, and we do not control for variables like spending that could be mediators. Together, these three factors allow us to provide the only comprehensive analysis of the precise underperformance of election-denying candidates across offices and incumbency status in the 2022 election cycle.

Our results also help to advance a long-running literature on candidate positioning and electoral outcomes in American elections. Empirical studies consistently estimate an advantage to more moderate candidates (Ansolabehere, Snyder, and Stewart 2001; Broockman and Kalla 2020; Canes-Wrone, Brady, and Cogan 2002; Caughey and Warshaw 2023; Hall 2015; Hall and Thompson 2018), and behavioral data suggest that swing voters remain important in determining election outcomes (Fowler et al. 2022; Hill, Hopkins, and Huber 2021). However, an important vein of behavioral research argues that Americans are too uninformed and/or too partisan to care much about other considerations like candidate positions (e.g., Achen and Bartels 2016; Campbell et al. 1960). As partisanship has increased in the American electorate, the relationship between challenger moderation and electoral performance has weakened in congressional elections (Canes-Wrone and Kistner 2022), and declined for both incumbents and nonincumbents in state legislative races (Handan-Nader, Myers, and Hall 2022). How much candidate positions matter in the current political climate is therefore very much in question.

Assessing how much the overall relationship between candidate positions and election outcomes has changed in congressional elections is challenging, for two related reasons. First, our ability to measure candidate positions has become threatened by the increasing polarization of Congress itself, which is causing problems with roll-call-based measures of incumbent ideology used in many studies of elections (Duck-Mayr and Montgomery 2023; Tausanovitch and Warshaw 2017). Second, to the extent that symbolic,

partisan “culture war” issues have become more salient than the traditional left–right divide over economic policies, standard approaches to scaling candidates may be less useful than before.

Beyond the general election, it is also important to understand the extent to which Republican primaries preferred election-denying candidates. Perhaps surprisingly, we estimate that election-denying Republicans outperformed primary opponents by only roughly 2 percentage points.⁷ Because the estimate does seem positive, however, it is at least roughly consistent with research exploring the perceived tradeoff primary voters face between voting for more-extreme candidates they prefer and voting for less-extreme candidates more likely to win the general election (e.g., Aranson and Ordeshook 1972; Brady, Han, and Pope 2007; Hill 2015; Owen and Grofman 2006).

There are two important limitations to our analysis. First, our analysis only measures the gap in electoral performance of statewide Republican candidates who denied or did not deny the 2020 election. Because it compares Republican candidates to one another, it differences out any penalty that may have accrued to the Republican party as a whole because of its association with the election-denying position of former President Trump and other candidates. Second, our estimate does not reflect the causal effect of a candidate switching her position on election denialism; rather, it summarizes how much worse election-denying candidates did than non-denying candidates. If election-denying candidates differ from non-denying candidates in their same states—for example, if they are less experienced, more ideologically extreme, or otherwise less popular candidates—these other differences would contribute to our estimate as well.

EMPIRICAL APPROACHES TO ACCOUNT FOR STATE PARTISANSHIP

We collect certified statewide election returns for 2022 directly from official state websites (Malzahn and Hall 2024).⁸ We combine these data with information on 2020 Republican presidential vote share collected from Dave Leip’s Election Atlas (Leip 2023). Ultimately, we analyze data for 42 states, excluding eight states that either did not have any two-party contested elections for Senate, governor, secretary of state, and attorney general (six states) or which use nonstandard election rules that lead to more than one general election candidate in one or both parties (two states).⁹

⁷ It is also arguably small relative to the high degree of polarization between Democrats and Republicans in terms of their self-reported views concerning election integrity and vote-by-mail in the 2020 election (Lockhart et al. 2020).

⁸ We were not able to find certified general election results for Kentucky, though we do have certified primary results. In that case, we used ballotpedia data.

⁹ Specifically, we exclude Mississippi, Montana, New Jersey, West Virginia, and Virginia because they held no elections for these offices in 2022. We exclude Utah because the only relevant election held was

⁵ Jacobson (2023) describes in prose a set of analyses on statewide races; however, no formal results are presented, and attorneys general races do not appear to be included. Bartels and Carnes (2023) only analyze House incumbents.

⁶ Jacobson (2023) controls for mediating variables, particularly spending, in part because the article is not focused on estimating the underperformance of election-denying candidates.

Classifying Republican candidates as denying the 2020 election is partially a subjective exercise. To avoid making our own judgment calls, we rely on three external datasets of election-denying candidates. The first, from States United Democracy Center (SUDC), is a list of Republican candidates for governor, secretary of state, and state attorney general who made public statements expressing skepticism about the 2020 election. SUDC is a nonpartisan organization founded by three former government officials that focuses on issues around American democracy.¹⁰ SUDC identifies Republican as having denied the election if, in the evaluation of the organization's experts, they claimed former President Trump was the rightful winner of the 2022 election instead of President Biden, spread lies regarding the election to the press or on social media, called for an audit of election results after they were certified, attended "Stop the Steal" rallies, or filed litigation to overturn election results (States United Democracy Center 2022). As this dataset is the only one to evaluate candidates in primary elections, it provides us unique leverage to examine the performance of election-denying candidates in primary elections. However, it does not include U.S. Senate or House candidates.

The second is a dataset from FiveThirtyEight (538) that the news organization created by contacting every Republican nominee and asking them about the 2020 election (FiveThirtyEight 2022). A key advantage to this dataset is that they include all statewide and congressional general election candidates; however, these data do not cover primary elections. Rather than classifying candidates as denying the 2020 election, 538 lists six possible kinds of stances each candidate could take. These stances are: "fully accepted," "accepted with reservations," "avoided answering," "no comment," "raised questions," and "fully denied." We classify candidates in these data as denying the 2020 election only if they "fully denied" the 2020 election, though in the Supplementary Material we show that results are robust to expanding this definition.

The third is a dataset from the *Washington Post* (WaPo) that uses a method nearly identical to SUDC to inductively classify election deniers. Unlike SUDC, WaPo includes all statewide and congressional candidates, giving us better coverage. In addition to using these three classifications separately, we also combine them by generating a variable that classifies any Republican candidate as denying the 2020 election if they are classified as doing so by SUDC, 538, or WaPo.

A concern with these measures could be that some election-denying candidates are not detected because they do not show up saliently in news sources as an election-denying candidate. The 538 data are reassuring in this regard because they are exhaustive—they contacted every candidate under study. Our

consolidated measure is also helpful because it casts as wide a net as possible across all three sources. Nevertheless, there could be candidates who at different points denied the election but were not detected by these sources. To the extent these candidates exist, it could attenuate our estimate of the underperformance to election-denying candidates by leading us to accidentally include some denying candidates in the control group of our regressions. However, given the strength of our data sources, we think this bias is likely to be small if it exists.

Focusing only on Republican statewide candidates, we run regressions of the form

$$\text{Repub Vote Share}_{is} = \beta \text{Deny 2020}_i + \delta X_{is} + \epsilon_{is}, \quad (1)$$

where the outcome is the vote share for Republican statewide candidate i in state s in the 2022 election. The variable Deny 2020_i is a binary variable indicating whether candidate i officially denied the results of the 2020 election. The variable X_{is} represents a control for either state-level presidential vote share or state fixed effects to account for possible confounding where states with more election-denying candidates in 2022 are states where Republican vote shares are generally higher. Finally, ϵ_{is} is the error term which we expect to feature autocorrelation within states.

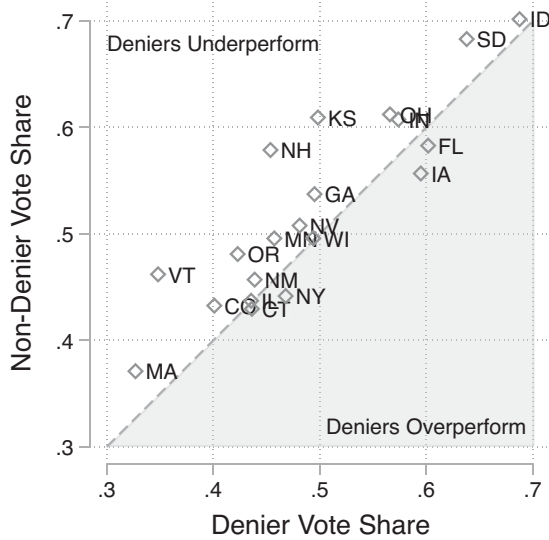
UNDERPERFORMANCE OF ELECTION-DENYING CANDIDATES IN 2022

Before presenting our estimates, it is valuable to understand the distribution of election-denying candidates across races and offices. Figure SI.2 in the Supplementary Material plots the number of denying and non-denying candidates across office and incumbency status. In all four offices, non-denying candidates outnumber denying ones by a wide margin. Using our combined measure of election denialism, we find 10 election-denying candidates in AG elections, 19 in gubernatorial, 13 in senatorial, and 10 in secretary of state races. While we find roughly equal numbers of incumbent and non-incumbent election-denying candidates for governor, we find fewer incumbent and more nonincumbent election-denying candidates for AG, senator, and especially secretary of state, where there are actually no election-denying incumbent candidates. Finally, there are a total of 20 states in which we see Republican election-denying and non-denying candidates on the same ballot.

Figure 1 explains which states featured the most underperformance by election-denying candidates, focusing on states that featured Republican candidates who did and did not deny the 2020 election—as mentioned above, this focuses on 20 states in our data. The plot shows the election-denying candidates' average vote share in the state on the horizontal axis, and the non-election-denying candidates' average vote share in the state on the vertical axis. Points above the 45-degree line are states where the non-denying candidates outperformed the denying candidates. As the figure shows,

for Senate and there was no Democratic opponent. Finally, we exclude Alaska and Louisiana due to the presence of co-partisan opponents in the general election. While California uses a top-2 system that could also lead to these issues, in the 2022 elections for the offices we include, the general elections ended up being standard D vs. R races.

¹⁰ See <https://statesuniteddemocracy.org/>.

FIGURE 1. Comparing 2022 Vote Shares of Statewide Republican Candidates Who Denied vs. Did Not Deny the Results of the 2020 Election and Ran in the Same State

while many states are quite close to the 45-degree line, there are more states above and to the left of the line, indicating places where election-denying candidates underperformed.

Table 1 presents the formal estimates. The first four columns present our more-precise statistical estimates where we pool the data while controlling for state-level 2020 presidential vote share, which allows us to include more states. The second set of four columns present estimates where we instead use state fixed effects, focusing on comparisons between Republican candidates running in the same state who vary in their election denialism. This latter specification can address potential

changes in state partisanship between 2020 and 2022, but at the cost of using less of the data and therefore lowering our statistical precision. Specifically, state fixed effects only allow us to estimate a penalty for states with variation in the candidate denier classification, leaving us with as few as 11 states for the SUDC measure and as many as 21 states for the WaPo measure.

Columns 1 and 5 use the SUDC classification of election-denying candidates (which do not include Senate races), columns 2 and 6 use the 538 classification, columns 3 and 7 use the WaPo classification, and columns 4 and 8 use the combined measure we created, described above.

As the results show, we find a relatively consistent underperformance for election-denying Republicans compared to other Republicans, ranging from as large as 4.5 percentage points (column 5) to 2.0 percentage points (column 6). Our most precise estimates (in terms of lowest standard error) are in columns 2–4, across which we estimate at least a 2.6 percentage point underperformance using the 538 classification. Column 8 remains our ex ante preferred specification, where we use the combined measure and state fixed effects and estimate an underperformance of 3.2 percentage points relative to other Republicans.

LACK OF UNDERPERFORMANCE FOR ELECTION-DENYING CANDIDATES IN THE U.S. HOUSE

We can also perform a similar analysis for the U.S. House. Because we do not have access to statewide offices' vote shares by congressional district, we cannot pursue the fixed-effects strategy from above, where we compute the difference between election-denying and non-denying candidates within the same constituency. But we can control for presidential vote share at the House district level, paralleling the other strategy we took at the state level previously. Table 2

TABLE 1. Underperformance of Election-Denying Candidates in 2022 Races for Governor, Senator, Secretary of State, and Attorney General

	General election vote share							
	States United 1	538 2	WaPo 3	Combined 4	States United 5	538 6	WaPo 7	Combined 8
Election-denying candidate	-0.033	-0.026	-0.030	-0.029	-0.045	-0.020	-0.028	-0.032
	(0.015)	(0.010)	(0.010)	(0.010)	(0.026)	(0.012)	(0.013)	(0.012)
N	85	116	116	116	32	53	72	68
No. of states	38	42	42	42	11	16	21	20
Pres. vote share	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	No
State FEs	No	No	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

Note: Sample is Republican candidates for attorney general, secretary of state, governor, and U.S. Senate. Robust standard errors clustered by state in parentheses. Columns labeled States United use election denier classifications from SUDC, which do not include Senate or House races. Columns labeled 538 use election denier classifications from FiveThirtyEight. Rows labeled WaPo use election denier classifications from the *Washington Post*. Columns 1–4 include controls for 2020 presidential vote share.

TABLE 2. Neutral Performance of Election-Denying Candidates in 2022 Races for House

	General election vote share		
	538	WaPo	Combined
	1	2	3
Election-denying candidate	0.001 (0.004)	−0.000 (0.004)	−0.000 (0.003)
N	393	393	393
Pres. vote share	Yes	Yes	Yes

Note: Sample is Republican candidates for U.S. House. Robust standard errors clustered by state in parentheses. Columns labeled 538 use election denier classifications from FiveThirtyEight. Columns labeled WaPo use election denier classifications from the *Washington Post*. Columns labeled combined classify candidates as denying the election if either WaPo or 538 classify them as an election denier. Columns 1–3 include controls for 2020 presidential vote share.

presents the results. As the table shows, we find no evidence for underperformance by election-denying candidates at the House level. In our preferred specification in column 3, we estimate a 0 percentage point difference, with a 95% confidence interval lower-bound of −0.6 percentage points. Though we use a different measure of denialism, this is broadly consistent with the results in Bartels and Carnes (2023).

Statewide races differ from House races in ways relevant to an election denial penalty. To start, statewide offices have more direct and concentrated power over election administration and certification, which makes their position on this issue more consequential. Secretaries of State directly administer state elections. Attorney generals play key roles in any state-level election litigation. Governors can block or sign state legislation to fund elections or change election laws. Additionally, with smaller districts that are often much more partisan, House candidates who deny the election may have been able to do so while alienating a smaller proportion of their voters. Moreover, in safe Republican districts where primary elections matter more than general elections, incumbents who accepted the results of the 2020 election may have had more to fear. Indeed, Representatives Anthony Gonzalez (R-OH), Adam Kinzinger (R-IL), and John Katko (R-NY) all opted to retire rather than face a potential election-denying opponent in their next primary, indicating the expectation of a penalty. As another example, Rep. Tom Rice (R-SC) lost a primary challenge to Rep. Russell Fry who fully denied the 2020 election.

In the Supplementary Material, we present estimates for the House, Senate, and statewide races that consider incumbency status. Interestingly, we find variation across offices. In governor and AG races, the underperformance of election-denying candidates appears to be larger for nonincumbents than for incumbents, while the opposite appears to be the case for the House and Senate.

POSSIBLE ADVANTAGE OF ELECTION-DENYING CANDIDATES IN PRIMARY ELECTIONS

In the Supplementary Material, we also explore whether election-denying candidates for secretary of state, governor, and attorney general are advantaged in primary elections. Perhaps surprisingly, we imprecisely estimate only a small advantage of 0.019 with a standard error of 0.031. This advantage is consistent with the notion that there is a tradeoff between primary elections that favor more-extreme candidates and general elections that favor more-moderate candidates (Hall 2015), but the imprecision in our estimates makes it difficult to draw strong conclusions.

CONCLUSION

Understanding the degree to which voters in 2022 rejected election-denying candidates is important for understanding how American democracy might function in future election cycles and for assessing how the potential links between candidate positions and electoral outcomes are changing in congressional elections. Although we know that many election-denying candidates lost key state-level races in 2022, we lack a precise empirical sense of how strongly the American electorate punished candidates who espoused these views. The purpose of this study is to put together the data necessary to quantify this underperformance systematically. We find that election-denying candidates underperformed in 2022 by a margin substantial enough to suggest that it could tip close elections in the future. On the other hand, the underperformance of election-denying candidates that we document is also small enough to suggest that many voters were willing to continue supporting Republican candidates even if they denied the results of the 2020 election.

SUPPLEMENTARY MATERIAL

To view supplementary material for this article, please visit <https://doi.org/10.1017/S0003055424001084>.

DATA AVAILABILITY STATEMENT

Research documentation and data that support the findings of this study are openly available at the American Political Science Review Dataverse: <https://doi.org/10.7910/DVN/JPKJSJ>.

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

For comments and helpful suggestions, the authors thank Justin Grimmer and Kelly Rader as well as participants of the EOLDN-Hoover Conference.

FUNDING STATEMENT

This research was supported in part by funding from the States United Democracy Center.

CONFLICT OF INTEREST

The authors declare no ethical issues or conflicts of interest in this research.

ETHICAL STANDARDS

The authors affirm this research did not involve human participants.

REFERENCES

- Achen, Christopher H., and Larry M. Bartels. 2016. *Democracy for Realists: Why Elections Do Not Produce Responsive Government*. Princeton, NJ: Princeton University Press.
- Ansolabehere, Stephen, James M. Snyder Jr., and Charles Stewart, III. 2001. "Candidate Positioning in US House Elections." *American Journal of Political Science* 45 (1): 136–59.
- Aranson, Peter H., and Peter C. Ordeshook. 1972. "Spatial Strategy for Sequential Elections." In *Probability Models of Collective Decision Making*, eds. Richard G. Niemi, and Herbert F. Weisberg, 298–331. Columbus, OH: Merrill.
- Bartels, Larry M., and Nicholas Carnes. 2023. "House Republicans were Rewarded for Supporting Donald Trump's 'Stop the Steal' Efforts." *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* 120 (34): e2309072120.
- Brady, David W., Hahrie Han, and Jeremy C. Pope. 2007. "Primary Elections and Candidate Ideology: Out of Step with the Primary Electorate?" *Legislative Studies Quarterly* 32 (1): 79–105.
- Broockman, David, and Joshua Kalla. 2020. "Candidate Ideology and Vote Choice in the 2020 US Presidential Election." OSF Preprints. <https://osf.io/25wm9>.
- Campbell, Angus, Philip E. Converse, Warren E. Miller, and Donald E. Stokes. 1960. *The American Voter*. Chicago, IL: University of Chicago Press.
- Canes-Wrone, Brandice, David W. Brady, and John F. Cogan. 2002. "Out of Step, Out of Office: Electoral Accountability and House Members' Voting." *American Political Science Review* 96 (1): 127–40.
- Canes-Wrone, Brandice, and Michael R. Kistner. 2022. "Out of Step and Still in Congress? Electoral Consequences of Incumbent and Challenger Positioning across Time." *Quarterly Journal of Political Science* 17 (3): 389–420.
- Caughey, Devin, and Christopher Warshaw. 2023. *Dynamic Democracy: Citizens, Politicians, and Policymaking in the American States*. Chicago, IL: University of Chicago Press.
- Duck-Mayr, JBrandon, and Jacob Montgomery. 2023. "Ends against the Middle: Measuring Latent Traits When Opposites Respond the Same Way for Antithetical Reasons." *Political Analysis* 31 (4): 1–20.
- FiveThirtyEight. 2022. "60 Percent of Americans will have an Election Denier on the Ballot this Fall." *FiveThirtyEight*. <https://projects.fivethirtyeight.com/republicans-trump-election-fraud/>.
- Fowler, Anthony, Seth J. Hill, Jeffrey B. Lewis, Chris Tausanovitch, Lynn Vavreck, and Christopher Warshaw. 2022. "Moderates." *American Political Science Review* 117 (2): 643–60.
- Graham, Matthew H., and Milan W. Svoblik. 2020. "Democracy in America? Partisanship, Polarization, and the Robustness of Support for Democracy in the United States." *American Political Science Review* 114 (2): 392–409.
- Hall, Andrew B. 2015. "What Happens When Extremists Win Primaries?" *American Political Science Review* 109 (1): 18–42.
- Hall, Andrew B., and Daniel M. Thompson. 2018. "Who Punishes Extremist Nominees? Candidate Ideology and Turning Out the Base in U.S. Elections." *American Political Science Review* 112 (3): 509–24.
- Handan-Nader, Cassandra, Andrew C. W. Myers, and Andrew B. Hall. 2022. "Polarization and State Legislative Elections." Working Paper. https://stanforddpl.org/papers/handan-nader_myers_hall_polarization_2022/handan-nader_myers_hall_polarization_2022.pdf.
- Hill, Seth J. 2015. "Institution of Nomination and the Policy Ideology of Primary Electorates." *Quarterly Journal of Political Science* 10 (4): 461–87.
- Hill, Seth J., Daniel J. Hopkins, and Gregory A. Huber. 2021. "Not by Turnout Alone: Measuring the Sources of Electoral Change, 2012 to 2016." *Science Advances* 7 (17): eabe3272.
- Jacobson, Gary C. 2023. "The 2022 Elections: A Test of Democracy's Resilience and the Referendum Theory of Midterms." *Political Science Quarterly* 138 (1): 1–22.
- Leip, David. 2023. "Dave Leip's Atlas of U.S. Presidential Elections." Dataset. <http://uselectionatlas.org>.
- Lockhart, Mackenzie, Seth J. Hill, Jennifer Merolla, Mindy Romero, and Thad Kousser. 2020. "America's Electorate is Increasingly Polarized along Partisan Lines about Voting by Mail during the COVID-19 Crisis." *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* 117 (40): 24640–2.
- Malzahn, Janet, and Andrew B. Hall. 2024. "Replication Data for: Election-Denying Republican Candidates Underperformed in the 2022 Midterms." Harvard Dataverse. Dataset. <https://doi.org/10.7910/DVN/JPKJSJ>.
- Owen, Guillermo, and Bernard Grofman. 2006. "Two-Stage Electoral Competition in Two-Party Contests: Persistent Divergence of Party Positions." *Social Choice and Welfare* 26 (3): 547–69.
- States United Action. 2022. "Replacing the Refs." *States United Democracy Center*. <https://electiondeniers.org/>.
- Tausanovitch, Chris, and Christopher Warshaw. 2017. "Estimating Candidates' Political Orientation in a Polarized Congress." *Political Analysis* 25 (2): 167–87.